

How This Deck Works

Universal Design for Learning · Multi-Tiered System of Supports

EVERY LEARNER · SAME FIRM GOAL

Multiple ways in

Every lesson opens with a real question and a clear “I can” goal, so you know why it matters and where you’re headed.

Multiple ways to see it

Direct instruction, primary sources, maps, and bilingual key vocabulary — the same ideas shown more than one way.

Multiple ways to show it

Model-with-me, sentence frames, and choices in how you respond — you reach the same goal by the route that works for you.

*Your teacher checks your progress along the way and gives you another path if you need one — **the goal never lowers.***

US.45

Rise and Spread of Fascism, Communism, and Totalitarianism

TN STANDARD

US.45 – Explain the rise and spread of fascism, communism, and totalitarianism internationally.

I CAN

I can explain the rise and spread of fascism, communism, and totalitarianism internationally, including the key characteristics and leaders of each system.

Fascism and communism rose as rival extremes — fascism preached ultranationalism, dictatorship, and militarism, while communism preached class struggle, proletarian revolution, and state ownership of the means of production.

KEY POINT

Fascism and communism rose as rival extremes — fascism preached ultranationalism, dictatorship, and militarism, while communism preached class struggle, proletarian revolution, and state ownership of the means of production.

Totalitarian states seized total control — in Italy, Germany, and the Soviet Union, one-party regimes under Mussolini, Hitler, and Stalin used propaganda, secret police, and terror to dominate all public and private life.

ZOOM IN



The Great Depression opened the door — economic collapse, resentment over the Treaty of Versailles, weak democracies, and fear of communism pushed desperate populations toward radical, authoritarian solutions.

KEY POINT

The Great Depression opened the door — economic collapse, resentment over the Treaty of Versailles, weak democracies, and fear of communism pushed desperate populations toward radical, authoritarian solutions.

Read Mussolini's "The Doctrine of Fascism" — weigh who wrote it and why before you read the words.

WHO

Benito Mussolini

WHEN

1932

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

The Doctrine of Fascism

Benito Mussolini · 1932

"The Fascist State organizes the nation, but leaves a sufficient margin of liberty to the individual; the latter is deprived of all useless and possibly harmful freedom, but retains what is essential; the deciding power in this question cannot be the individual, but the State alone... The Fascist conception of the State is all-embracing; outside of it no human or spiritual values can exist, much less have value."

[Internet Archive](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.45:

Dictators and their parties who seized total power, and industrialists and elites who backed strongmen to crush labor movements and communism.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.45:

Political dissidents, ethnic and religious minorities, and ordinary citizens who lost civil liberties, free press, and eventually their lives under state terror.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.45:

Single-party dictatorships that abolished checks on power — Mussolini, Hitler, and Stalin ruling through propaganda, secret police, and force.

Anchor: The Doctrine of Fascism, Benito Mussolini, 1932 (Internet Archive)

Words you need before we read

Fascism

En español: *Fascismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

An authoritarian political ideology that emphasizes extreme nationalism, militarism, totalitarian control, and a dictatorial leader. Suppresses opposition and glorifies the state above individual rights.

Totalitarianism

En español: *Totalitarismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A system of government where the state controls every aspect of public and private life, using propaganda, secret police, and terror to eliminate opposition.

Communism

En español: *Comunismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A political and economic system in which the state owns property and the means of production in the name of the working class; in the 20th century it took the form of one-party dictatorship under leaders like...

Check your understanding

How did economic crisis and political instability enable the rise of totalitarian regimes in Italy, Germany, and the Soviet Union?

- A** The Great Depression, post-WWI disappointment, and political chaos created conditions where people accepted radical solutions and strong leaders promising stability
- B** Economic prosperity led people to seek stronger government control, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which does not align with the documented historical record
- C** Totalitarian regimes rose during periods of peace and prosperity, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D** Democratic governments actively promoted totalitarianism, which does not align with the documented historical record, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.46

FDR's Response to World Crises

TN STANDARD

US.46 – Explain President Franklin D. Roosevelt's response to world crises, including: The Quarantine Speech, the Four Freedoms speech, the Atlantic Charter, and the Lend-Lease Act.

I CAN

I can explain President Franklin D. Roosevelt's response to world crises, including the Quarantine Speech, the Four Freedoms speech, the Atlantic Charter, and the Lend-Lease Act.

FDR warned against aggression, then defined the stakes — the 1937 Quarantine Speech urged isolating aggressor nations, and the 1941 Four Freedoms Speech framed the coming struggle around freedom of speech, worship, from want, and from fear.

ZOOM IN



US.46 · Quarantine Speech & Four Freedoms

The Atlantic Charter set Allied war aims — meeting Churchill secretly off Newfoundland in August 1941, FDR set postwar principles of self-determination and collective security before the U.S. had even entered the war.

KEY POINT

The Atlantic Charter set Allied war aims — meeting Churchill secretly off Newfoundland in August 1941, FDR set postwar principles of self-determination and collective security before the U.S. had even entered the war.

Lend-Lease made America the “arsenal of democracy” — the March 1941 Lend-Lease Act let the U.S. supply Britain and the Allies with military equipment without immediate payment, ending strict neutrality short of war.

KEY POINT

Lend-Lease made America the “arsenal of democracy” — the March 1941 Lend-Lease Act let the U.S. supply Britain and the Allies with military equipment without immediate payment, ending strict neutrality short of war.

Read FDR's Four Freedoms Speech — identify the speaker, date, and purpose before you weigh his words.

WHO

President Franklin D. Roosevelt

WHEN

January 6, 1941

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

The Four Freedoms Speech

President Franklin D. Roosevelt · January 6, 1941

"In the future days, which we seek to make secure, we look forward to a world founded upon four essential human freedoms. The first is freedom of speech and expression—everywhere in the world. The second is freedom of every person to worship God in his own way—everywhere in the world. The third is freedom from want... The fourth is freedom from fear."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.46:

Britain and the Allies, kept in the war by American supplies, and U.S. defense industries that expanded under Lend-Lease production.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.46:

Isolationists whose influence FDR steadily eroded, and Axis powers whose enemies were now backed by American industrial might.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.46:

President Roosevelt, who steered a neutral nation toward the Allies, and Congress, which passed Lend-Lease over isolationist objection.

Anchor: The Four Freedoms Speech, President Franklin D. Roosevelt, January 6, 1941 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Quarantine Speech

En español: *Discurso de la Cuarentena*

WHAT IT MEANS

FDR's 1937 address proposing that peace-loving nations 'quarantine' aggressor states to halt the spread of international lawlessness.

Four Freedoms Speech

En español: *Discurso de las Cuatro Libertades*

WHAT IT MEANS

FDR's 1941 speech defining American war aims: freedom of speech, freedom of worship, freedom from want, and freedom from fear.

Lend-Lease Act (1941)

En español: *Ley de Préstamo y Arriendo (1941)*

WHAT IT MEANS

U.S. program allowing the President to lend or lease war supplies to any nation deemed vital to American defense, primarily Britain and the Soviet Union.

Check your understanding

How did the Atlantic Charter establish principles for the post-war international order?

- A** It focused only on immediate military strategy, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- B** It established principles including self-determination, free trade, collective security, and disarmament that became the foundation for the United Nations and post-war international law
- C** It divided the world into American and British spheres of influence, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D** It had no lasting impact on international relations, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.47

U.S. Response to the Holocaust

TN STANDARD

US.47 – Analyze the response of the U.S. to the plight of European Jews before the start of the war, the U.S. liberation of concentration camps during the war, and the immigration of Holocaust survivors after the war.

I CAN

I can analyze the response of the U.S. to the plight of European Jews before the war, the liberation of concentration camps during the war, and the immigration of Holocaust survivors after the war.

Restrictive immigration limited America's prewar response — the 1924 National Origins Act capped immigration from the regions where most European Jews lived, and quotas were rarely filled even as Nazi persecution intensified.

KEY POINT

Restrictive immigration limited America's prewar response — the 1924 National Origins Act capped immigration from the regions where most European Jews lived, and quotas were rarely filled even as Nazi persecution intensified.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.47

Allied forces liberated the concentration camps — as the war ended, Soviet forces freed Majdanek and Auschwitz, and U.S. forces freed Buchenwald and Dachau, exposing the full horror of the Holocaust to the world.

ZOOM IN



US.47 · Liberation of the Camps

Postwar policy slowly opened the door to survivors — the 1948 Displaced Persons Act admitted survivors, and Kristallnacht and the Holocaust reshaped debates over refugees, human rights, and America's moral responsibility.

KEY POINT

Postwar policy slowly opened the door to survivors — the 1948 Displaced Persons Act admitted survivors, and Kristallnacht and the Holocaust reshaped debates over refugees, human rights, and America's moral responsibility.

Read Elie Wiesel's testimony of liberation — consider the witness, the moment, and the purpose before you read the account.

WHO

Elie Wiesel

WHEN

1945 (describing liberation)

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Testimony of Holocaust Survivor

Elie Wiesel · 1945 (describing liberation)

"On April 10, there were still some 20,000 prisoners in the camp, including several hundred children. It was decided to evacuate all of us at once... On April 11, at about six o'clock in the evening, the first American tanks stood at the gates of Buchenwald. Our first act as free men was to throw ourselves onto the provisions. That's all we thought about. Nothing else mattered."

[United States Holocaust Memorial Museum](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.47:

Survivors eventually admitted after the war, and postwar human-rights and refugee efforts that grew from the world's reckoning with the Holocaust.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.47:

Six million murdered European Jews and millions of other victims, and refugees turned away by restrictive prewar immigration quotas.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.47:

Nazi Germany, which carried out genocide; and the U.S. government, whose immigration quotas and wartime priorities shaped a limited response.

Anchor: Testimony of Holocaust Survivor, Elie Wiesel, 1945 (describing liberation) (United States Holocaust Memorial Museum)

Words you need before we read

Holocaust

En español: *Holocausto*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nazi Germany's systematic genocide of 6 million Jews and millions of others (Roma, disabled, homosexuals, political opponents) during World War II.

Nuremberg Laws (1935)

En español: *Leyes de Nuremberg (1935)*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nazi racial laws that stripped Jews of German citizenship, banned intermarriage between Jews and non-Jews, and defined "Jewishness" by ancestry. They institutionalized anti-Semitic persecution.

Adolf Hitler

En español: *Adolf Hitler*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nazi dictator of Germany (1933-1945) who led Germany into World War II and orchestrated the Holocaust, resulting in the deaths of 6 million Jews and millions of others.

Check your understanding

How did U.S. immigration restrictions and public attitudes limit American response to Jewish refugees before WWII?

- A** The U.S. welcomed all Jewish refugees without restriction, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- B** Only economic factors affected refugee policy, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- C** The National Origins Act quotas, consular obstruction, anti-Semitism, isolationism, and economic fears during the Depression combined to severely limit Jewish immigration
- D** The U.S. had no immigration restrictions in the 1930s, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.48

American Entry into World War II

TN STANDARD

US.48 – Explain the reasons for American entry into World War II, including the attack on Pearl Harbor.

I CAN

I can explain the reasons for American entry into World War II, including the attack on Pearl Harbor.

An undeclared naval war pulled the U.S. toward Europe — German U-boats attacked American ships carrying Lend-Lease supplies, drawing the United States into an escalating undeclared war in the Atlantic.

KEY POINT

An undeclared naval war pulled the U.S. toward Europe — German U-boats attacked American ships carrying Lend-Lease supplies, drawing the United States into an escalating undeclared war in the Atlantic.

Pacific tensions escalated toward war — Japanese expansion across China and Southeast Asia threatened U.S. interests, and an American oil and steel embargo pushed Japan to plan a surprise strike.

KEY POINT

Pacific tensions escalated toward war — Japanese expansion across China and Southeast Asia threatened U.S. interests, and an American oil and steel embargo pushed Japan to plan a surprise strike.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.48

Pearl Harbor ended American neutrality — the December 7, 1941 surprise attack on the U.S. Pacific Fleet destroyed isolationist opposition, unified public opinion, and brought the United States fully into World War II.

ZOOM IN



US.48 · Attack on Pearl Harbor & Its Consequences

Read FDR's "Day of Infamy" Speech — note the speaker, date, and purpose before you read his words.

WHO

President Franklin D. Roosevelt

WHEN

December 8, 1941

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Day of Infamy Speech

President Franklin D. Roosevelt · December 8, 1941

"Yesterday, December 7th, 1941—a date which will live in infamy—the United States of America was suddenly and deliberately attacked by naval and air forces of the Empire of Japan. The United States was at peace with that nation and, at the solicitation of Japan, was still in conversation with its government and its Emperor looking toward the maintenance of peace in the Pacific."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.48:

The Allied cause, joined by America's full industrial and military power, and interventionists whose warnings were vindicated by the attack.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.48:

The 2,400 killed at Pearl Harbor, the sailors and civilians of the Pacific Fleet, and the millions of Americans soon sent to war.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.48:

Japan's military leaders, who ordered the attack; and President Roosevelt and Congress, who declared war the next day.

Anchor: Day of Infamy Speech, President Franklin D. Roosevelt, December 8, 1941 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Pearl Harbor

En español: *Pearl Harbor*

WHAT IT MEANS

Japan's surprise attack on the U.S. naval base in Hawaii on December 7, 1941, killing over 2,400 Americans and bringing the United States into World War II.

Hideki Tojo

En español: *Hideki Tojo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Japanese military leader and Prime Minister (1941-1944) who led Japan into World War II and authorized the attack on Pearl Harbor.

Axis Powers

En español: *Potencias del Eje*

WHAT IT MEANS

Military alliance of Germany, Italy, and Japan during World War II. United by shared goals of territorial expansion, militarism, and opposition to democratic nations.

Check your understanding

How did the Pearl Harbor attack unite American public opinion and end isolationism?

- A** Public opinion remained divided after Pearl Harbor, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- B** Isolationism continued throughout the war, but the historical record tells a more complex story and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- C** Pearl Harbor had no effect on public opinion, but the historical record tells a more complex story and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- D** The surprise attack shocked Americans, Roosevelt's "Date of Infamy" speech galvanized the nation, and Congress declared war with only one dissenting vote, destroying isolationist opposition

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.49

WWII Leaders & Key Figures

TN STANDARD

US.49 – Identify the roles and the significant actions of the following individuals in World War II: Winston Churchill, Dwight D. Eisenhower, Adolf Hitler, Douglas MacArthur, George C. Marshall, Benito Mussolini, President Franklin D. Roosevelt, Joseph Stalin, Hideki Tojo, President Harry S. Truman.

I CAN

I can identify the roles and the significant actions of key individuals in World War II, including Churchill, Eisenhower, Hitler, MacArthur, Marshall, Mussolini, FDR, Stalin, Tojo, and Truman.

Allied leaders rallied nations and coalitions — Churchill inspired British resistance, FDR marshaled American production, and Stalin drove the Soviet war effort on the Eastern Front against Nazi Germany.

KEY POINT

Allied leaders rallied nations and coalitions — Churchill inspired British resistance, FDR marshaled American production, and Stalin drove the Soviet war effort on the Eastern Front against Nazi Germany.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.49

Allied commanders planned victory in two theaters — Eisenhower directed D-Day and the war in Europe, while MacArthur and Nimitz led the island-hopping campaign that carried the fight across the Pacific to Japan.

ZOOM IN



US.49 · Allied Military Leaders

Axis leaders drove aggression and defeat — Hitler's blitzkrieg and invasion of the USSR, Mussolini's fascist Italy, and Japan's militarist expansion set the course of the war and ended in the collapse of all three regimes.

KEY POINT

Axis leaders drove aggression and defeat — Hitler's blitzkrieg and invasion of the USSR, Mussolini's fascist Italy, and Japan's militarist expansion set the course of the war and ended in the collapse of all three regimes.

Read Churchill's "We Shall Fight on the Beaches" Speech — weigh the speaker, moment, and audience before you read the words.

WHO

Winston Churchill

WHEN

June 4, 1940

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

We Shall Fight on the Beaches Speech

Winston Churchill · June 4, 1940

"We shall fight on the beaches, we shall fight on the landing grounds, we shall fight in the fields and in the streets, we shall fight in the hills; we shall never surrender, and even if, which I do not for a moment believe, this Island or a large part of it were subjugated and starving, then our Empire beyond the seas... would carry on the struggle."

[International Churchill Society](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.49:

The Allied nations and their peoples, freed from Axis conquest, and leaders like Churchill and Eisenhower whose reputations were cemented by victory.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.49:

The tens of millions of soldiers and civilians killed worldwide, and the populations subjected to Axis occupation and total war.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.49:

The Allied and Axis heads of state and their top commanders, whose strategic decisions directed the movements of entire armies.

Anchor: We Shall Fight on the Beaches Speech, Winston Churchill, June 4, 1940 (International Churchill Society)

Words you need before we read

Dwight D. Eisenhower

En español: *Dwight D. Eisenhower*

WHAT IT MEANS

Supreme Commander of Allied Forces in Europe who planned and led the D-Day invasion and coordinated Allied victory in Europe. Later became 34th President.

Adolf Hitler

En español: *Adolf Hitler*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nazi dictator of Germany (1933-1945) who led Germany into World War II and orchestrated the Holocaust, resulting in the deaths of 6 million Jews and millions of others.

Joseph Stalin

En español: *Joseph Stalin*

WHAT IT MEANS

Communist dictator of the Soviet Union (1924-1953) who ruled through terror, forced collectivization, and purges, resulting in millions of deaths.

Check your understanding

How did Allied leaders like Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin coordinate their war efforts despite different goals?

- A** Through conferences at Tehran and Yalta, the "Europe First" strategy, and division of responsibilities, they maintained cooperation despite tensions over post-war Europe and different ideological systems
- B** They never coordinated their efforts, which does not align with the documented historical record and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- C** Stalin made all decisions for the alliance, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- D** They fought completely separate wars, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.50

Major WWII Battles: Midway, Iwo Jima, Okinawa & D-Day

TN STANDARD

US.50 – Explain the role of geographic and military factors on the outcomes of battles in the Pacific and European theaters of war, including the Battles of Midway, Iwo Jima, Okinawa, and D-Day.

I CAN

I can explain the role of geographic and military factors on the outcomes of battles in the Pacific and European theaters, including Midway, Iwo Jima, Okinawa, and D-Day.

Midway turned the tide in the Pacific — in June 1942 American codebreaking and carrier air power sank four Japanese carriers at Midway Atoll, halting Japanese expansion and shifting the initiative to the United States.

KEY POINT

Midway turned the tide in the Pacific — in June 1942 American codebreaking and carrier air power sank four Japanese carriers at Midway Atoll, halting Japanese expansion and shifting the initiative to the United States.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.50

Iwo Jima and Okinawa showed the cost of nearing Japan — volcanic terrain and dug-in defenders made these 1945 battles among the war's bloodiest, and the staggering casualties shaped the decision to use the atomic bomb.

ZOOM IN



US.50 · Iwo Jima & Okinawa (1945)

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.50

D-Day opened the Western Front — on June 6, 1944, the largest amphibious invasion in history landed Allied forces on the beaches of Normandy, beginning the liberation of Western Europe from Nazi control.

ZOOM IN



US.50 · D-Day: Normandy Invasion (June 6, 1944)

Read Eisenhower's D-Day Order of the Day — identify the author, date, and purpose before you analyze the source.

WHO

General Dwight D. Eisenhower

WHEN

June 6, 1944

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Order of the Day - D-Day

General Dwight D. Eisenhower · June 6, 1944

"Soldiers, Sailors, and Airmen of the Allied Expeditionary Force! You are about to embark upon the Great Crusade, toward which we have striven these many months. The eyes of the world are upon you. The hope and prayers of liberty-loving people everywhere march with you... The tide has turned! The free men of the world are marching together to Victory!"

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.50:

The Allied cause and liberated peoples of Europe and the Pacific, as each victory brought the defeat of the Axis closer.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.50:

The soldiers killed and wounded storming beaches and islands, and civilians caught in some of the deadliest battles of the war.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.50:

Allied commanders like Eisenhower and Nimitz, who chose where and when to strike based on geographic and strategic advantage.

Anchor: Order of the Day - D-Day, General Dwight D. Eisenhower, June 6, 1944 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

D-Day (Normandy Invasion)

En español: *Día D (Invasión de Normandía)*

WHAT IT MEANS

June 6, 1944 Allied invasion of Nazi-occupied France across the beaches of Normandy, the largest amphibious assault in history, turning point of the war in Europe.

Battle of Midway

En español: *Batalla de Midway*

WHAT IT MEANS

June 1942 decisive U.S. naval victory that stopped Japanese expansion in the Pacific and marked the turning point of the Pacific War.

Battle of Iwo Jima

En español: *Batalla de Iwo Jima*

WHAT IT MEANS

February-March 1945 brutal battle for a strategic Pacific island, famous for the iconic flag-raising photograph on Mount Suribachi.

Check your understanding

How did geographic features of the Pacific islands affect American military strategy in battles like Midway and Iwo Jima?

- A** Geography had no effect on Pacific strategy, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- B** Midway's central location made it strategically vital, while Iwo Jima's volcanic terrain created natural fortifications requiring costly direct assault to secure airfields needed for bombing Japan
- C** All Pacific islands were geographically identical, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D** American forces avoided geographic challenges entirely, which does not align with the documented historical record, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.51

Special Fighting Forces in WWII

TN STANDARD

US.51 – Identify the roles and sacrifices of individual American soldiers, as well as the unique contributions of special fighting forces such as the Tuskegee Airmen, the 442nd Regimental Combat team, the 101st Airborne, and the Navajo Code Talkers.

I CAN

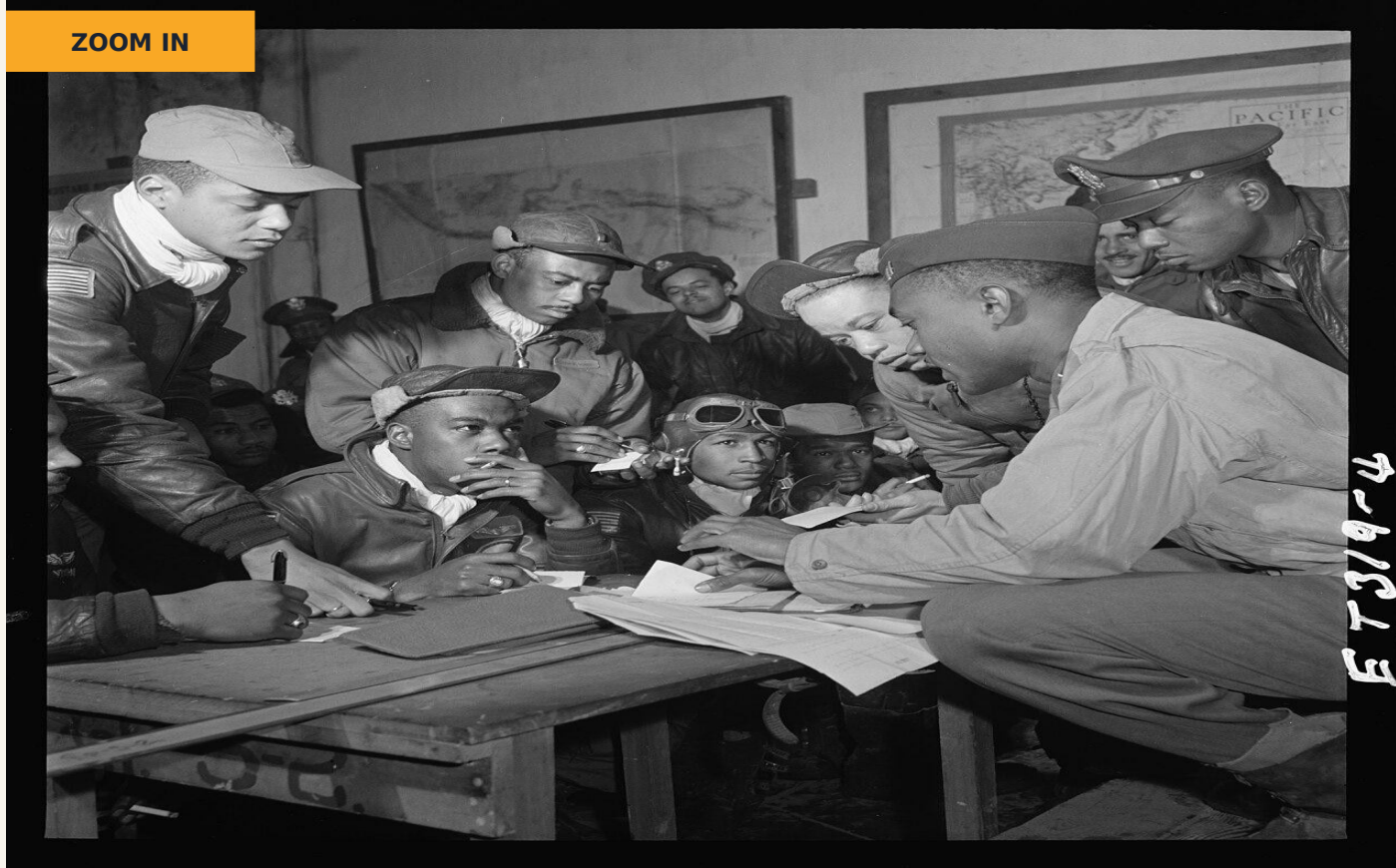
I can identify the roles and sacrifices of individual American soldiers and the unique contributions of special fighting forces such as the Tuskegee Airmen, the 442nd Regimental Combat Team, the 101st Airborne, and the Navajo Code Talkers.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.51

Segregated units proved themselves in combat — the Tuskegee Airmen, the first African American military aviators, escorted bombers with distinction, and the Japanese American 442nd became the most decorated unit of its size in U.S. history.

ZOOM IN



US.51 · Tuskegee Airmen & the 442nd

Specialized forces carried out decisive missions — the 101st Airborne “Screaming Eagles” parachuted into Normandy on D-Day, securing key objectives behind enemy lines to protect the invasion — a division with deep Tennessee ties at Fort Campbell.

KEY POINT

Specialized forces carried out decisive missions — the 101st Airborne “Screaming Eagles” parachuted into Normandy on D-Day, securing key objectives behind enemy lines to protect the invasion — a division with deep Tennessee ties at Fort Campbell.

Navajo Code Talkers created an unbreakable code — Navajo Marines used their native language to transmit secret messages the Japanese never broke, saving lives while these forces often fought two wars — one abroad and one against prejudice at home.

KEY POINT

Navajo Code Talkers created an unbreakable code — Navajo Marines used their native language to transmit secret messages the Japanese never broke, saving lives while these forces often fought two wars — one abroad and one against prejudice at home.

Read the Tuskegee Airmen Commendation — consider who issued it and why before you weigh its words.

WHO

U.S. Army Air Forces

WHEN

1945

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Tuskegee Airmen Commendation

U.S. Army Air Forces · 1945

"The 332nd Fighter Group has established an outstanding record by continuously outstanding performance of duty... Your formation has not lost a single bomber to enemy fighters. The determination, technique, and courage shown by your group in engaging enemy aircraft has been outstanding."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.51:

The Allied war effort, strengthened by these forces' skill, and the later civil-rights cause, which drew on their proven service and sacrifice.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.51:

Soldiers of color who fought and died while facing discrimination, and Japanese American troops whose families were interned at home.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.51:

The War Department and military commanders who deployed these units, and the soldiers themselves who volunteered despite injustice.

Anchor: Tuskegee Airmen Commendation, U.S. Army Air Forces, 1945 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Tuskegee Airmen

En español: *Aviadores de Tuskegee*

WHAT IT MEANS

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

442nd Regimental Combat Team

En español: *442º Equipo de Combate Regimental*

WHAT IT MEANS

All Japanese-American unit that became the most decorated unit in U.S. military history, fighting in Europe while their families were interned at home.

Navajo Code Talkers

En español: *Descifradores de Código Navajo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Navajo Marines who used their native language to create an unbreakable code for military communications in the Pacific theater.

Check your understanding

Why is the service of the 442nd Regimental Combat Team particularly significant given the internment of Japanese Americans?

- A** Their service had no connection to internment policies, but the historical record tells a more complex story, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- B** The 442nd was composed of non-Japanese American soldiers, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C** Japanese American soldiers volunteered to fight for a country that imprisoned their families, becoming the most decorated unit of their size while proving their loyalty despite profound injustice
- D** They served only in the Pacific theater, but this fails to account for the broader historical context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.52

Women in World War II

TN STANDARD

US.52 – Examine and explain the entry of large numbers of women into the workforce and armed forces during World War II and the subsequent impact on American society.

I CAN

I can examine and explain the entry of large numbers of women into the workforce and armed forces during World War II and the subsequent impact on American society.

Labor shortages drew women into war work — with 16 million men in uniform, a massive labor shortage opened defense-industry and armed-forces roles to women, embodied by the “Rosie the Riveter” image.

ZOOM IN



Women faced discrimination even as they built the war machine — they earned about 65% of men's wages in dangerous conditions, yet built bombers, ships, and munitions that were essential to Allied production.

KEY POINT

Women faced discrimination even as they built the war machine — they earned about 65% of men's wages in dangerous conditions, yet built bombers, ships, and munitions that were essential to Allied production.

The war reshaped women's long-term role — many were laid off for returning veterans and pushed back toward the home, but wartime work permanently changed expectations and helped lay groundwork for later movements.

KEY POINT

The war reshaped women's long-term role — many were laid off for returning veterans and pushed back toward the home, but wartime work permanently changed expectations and helped lay groundwork for later movements.

Read the War Production Board poster text — weigh who produced it and why before you read the message.

WHO

U.S. War Production Board

WHEN

1943

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

War Production Board Poster Text

U.S. War Production Board · 1943

"Do the job HE left behind. Women workers are needed in aircraft plants, shipyards, and munitions factories. Apply at your nearest U.S. Employment Service office. Every woman who takes a war job brings Victory closer. The more women at work—the sooner we win!"

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.52:

The war economy, powered by women's labor, and women who gained new skills, wages, and a lasting sense of capability.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.52:

Women paid less than men in hazardous jobs, then laid off after the war, and those pressured to abandon the workforce for returning veterans.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.52:

Government and industry that recruited women for the duration, then employers and social pressure that pushed them out at war's end.

Anchor: War Production Board Poster Text, U.S. War Production Board, 1943 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Rosie the Riveter

En español: *Rosie la Remachadora*

WHAT IT MEANS

Cultural icon representing millions of American women who worked in factories and shipyards during World War II, filling jobs left by men who went to war.

Tuskegee Airmen

En español: *Aviadores de Tuskegee*

WHAT IT MEANS

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

Rationing

En español: *Racionamiento*

WHAT IT MEANS

Government-controlled limits on consumer goods during WWII to ensure adequate supplies for the military, requiring ration books and coupons.

Check your understanding

How did "Rosie the Riveter" symbolize both opportunities and challenges facing working women?

- A** Rosie only represented challenges women faced, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which does not align with the documented historical record
- B** Rosie represented only wealthy women, which does not reflect the consensus among historians despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C** The symbol had no cultural significance, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D** Rosie symbolized women's capability and patriotic duty while obscuring challenges like lower pay, discrimination, inadequate childcare, and expectations to maintain domestic responsibilities

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.53

African Americans in WWII

TN STANDARD

US.53 – Examine the impact of World War II on economic and social conditions for African Americans, including the Fair Employment Practices Committee and the eventual integration of the armed forces by President Harry S. Truman. (TCA)

I CAN

I can examine the impact of World War II on economic and social conditions for African Americans, including the Fair Employment Practices Committee and the eventual integration of the armed forces by President Truman.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.53

The Second Great Migration reshaped Black America — 1.5 million African Americans moved North and West in the 1940s for defense-industry jobs, transforming cities like Detroit, Chicago, and Los Angeles.

ZOOM IN



US.53 · Second Great Migration & Opportunity

The Double V campaign linked the war to civil rights — the Pittsburgh Courier’s “Double V” demanded victory against fascism abroad and racism at home, framing wartime service as a claim on full citizenship.

KEY POINT

The Double V campaign linked the war to civil rights — the Pittsburgh Courier’s “Double V” demanded victory against fascism abroad and racism at home, framing wartime service as a claim on full citizenship.

Federal pressure opened jobs, then the military — A. Philip Randolph's threatened march won Executive Order 8802 and the FEPC banning defense-industry discrimination, and Executive Order 9981 later desegregated the armed forces.

KEY POINT

Federal pressure opened jobs, then the military — A. Philip Randolph's threatened march won Executive Order 8802 and the FEPC banning defense-industry discrimination, and Executive Order 9981 later desegregated the armed forces.

Read Executive Order 8802 — identify who issued it, when, and why before you analyze the source.

WHO

President Franklin D. Roosevelt

WHEN

June 25, 1941

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Executive Order 8802

President Franklin D. Roosevelt · June 25, 1941

"There shall be no discrimination in the employment of workers in defense industries or Government because of race, creed, color, or national origin... It is the duty of employers and of labor organizations... to provide for the full and equitable participation of all workers in defense industries."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.53:

African American workers who gained defense jobs, and the emerging civil-rights movement, energized by wartime demands for equality.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.53:

Black Americans who still faced segregation, violence, and discrimination even in war industries and a still-segregated military.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.53:

President Roosevelt, pressured by A. Philip Randolph, who issued EO 8802; and President Truman, who ordered military desegregation.

Anchor: Executive Order 8802, President Franklin D. Roosevelt, June 25, 1941 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Executive Order 8802

En español: *Orden Ejecutiva 8802*

WHAT IT MEANS

The June 1941 order signed by President Roosevelt banning racial discrimination in the defense industry and creating the Fair Employment Practices Committee.

Double V Campaign

En español: *Campaña de la Doble V*

WHAT IT MEANS

A World War II campaign led by the Black press calling for a 'Double Victory' - over fascism abroad and racial discrimination at home.

Tuskegee Airmen

En español: *Aviadores de Tuskegee*

WHAT IT MEANS

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

Check your understanding

What was the "Double V" campaign, and how did it connect the fight against fascism abroad with civil rights at home?

- A** The Pittsburgh Courier's campaign demanded victory over fascism abroad and over racism at home, arguing that fighting for democracy overseas exposed the contradiction of denying democracy to Black Americans
- B** It focused only on military victory, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which does not align with the documented historical record, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C** It supported segregation, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D** It had no connection to civil rights, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.54

Japanese American Internment & Korematsu

TN STANDARD

US.54 – Describe the constitutional issues and impact of the internment of Japanese Americans on the U.S., including the Fred Korematsu v. United States of America decision.

I CAN

I can describe the constitutional issues and impact of the internment of Japanese Americans on the U.S., including the Fred Korematsu v. United States of America decision.

Executive Order 9066 authorized mass internment — after Pearl Harbor, the February 1942 order forced roughly 120,000 Japanese Americans — most of them U.S. citizens — from their homes into remote camps.

ZOOM IN



US.54 · Executive Order 9066 & Internment

Internment violated core constitutional rights — people were removed without individual hearings, evidence of disloyalty, or due process, and were confined based solely on ancestry.

KEY POINT

Internment violated core constitutional rights — people were removed without individual hearings, evidence of disloyalty, or due process, and were confined based solely on ancestry.

Korematsu upheld internment, then history reversed it — in 1944 the Supreme Court upheld the exclusion order in *Korematsu v. United States*, but decades later the Civil Liberties Act of 1988 apologized and paid reparations.

KEY POINT

Korematsu upheld internment, then history reversed it — in 1944 the Supreme Court upheld the exclusion order in *Korematsu v. United States*, but decades later the Civil Liberties Act of 1988 apologized and paid reparations.

Read Executive Order 9066 — note who issued it, when, and why before you weigh its words.

WHO

President Franklin D. Roosevelt

WHEN

February 19, 1942

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Executive Order 9066

President Franklin D. Roosevelt · February 19, 1942

"I hereby authorize and direct the Secretary of War, and the Military Commanders whom he may from time to time designate... to prescribe military areas in such places and of such extent as he or the appropriate Military Commander may determine, from which any or all persons may be excluded."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.54:

Wartime officials who claimed security justification, and some who acquired the property Japanese Americans were forced to abandon.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.54:

120,000 interned Japanese Americans who lost homes, businesses, and freedom — an estimated \$400 million in property and lasting trauma.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.54:

President Roosevelt, who signed EO 9066; the military, which carried out removal; and the Supreme Court, which upheld it in Korematsu.

Anchor: Executive Order 9066, President Franklin D. Roosevelt, February 19, 1942 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Japanese Internment

En español: *Internamiento Japonés*

WHAT IT MEANS

The forced relocation and incarceration of 120,000 Japanese Americans (two-thirds U.S. citizens) in concentration camps during WWII, based on racial prejudice, not evidence of disloyalty.

Korematsu v. United States

En español: *Korematsu contra Estados Unidos*

WHAT IT MEANS

1944 Supreme Court decision upholding Japanese internment as a wartime necessity, later widely condemned as one of the Court's worst decisions.

Executive Order 9066

En español: *Orden Ejecutiva 9066*

WHAT IT MEANS

The February 1942 order signed by President Roosevelt authorizing the military to exclude and relocate Japanese Americans from the West Coast.

Check your understanding

How did Executive Order 9066 violate constitutional principles of due process and equal protection?

- A** It followed all constitutional procedures, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- B** It denied due process by detaining people without individual hearings or evidence, and violated equal protection by targeting Japanese Americans while not similarly treating German or Italian Americans
- C** It only affected non-citizens, but the historical record tells a more complex story, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- D** The Constitution does not protect against internment, which does not align with the documented historical record, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.55

Home Front Mobilization

TN STANDARD

US.55 – Describe the war's impact on the home front, including: rationing, bond drives, propaganda, movement to cities and industrial centers, Bracero program, conversion of factories for wartime production, location of prisoner of war camps in Tennessee.

I CAN

I can describe the war's impact on the home front, including rationing, bond drives, propaganda, movement to cities, the Bracero program, conversion of factories, and prisoner of war camps in Tennessee.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.55

Rationing and conservation reshaped daily life — ration books controlled civilian access to gasoline, tires, sugar, meat, and coffee, and victory gardens and scrap drives turned home-front sacrifice into war production.

ZOOM IN



Bonds and propaganda financed and unified the war — Liberty and Victory bond drives funded the war and gave civilians a direct stake, while government propaganda sustained morale and mobilized the public.

KEY POINT

Bonds and propaganda financed and unified the war — Liberty and Victory bond drives funded the war and gave civilians a direct stake, while government propaganda sustained morale and mobilized the public.

Wartime migration and Tennessee's role transformed communities — millions moved to defense centers, straining housing, while Tennessee hosted training installations, POW camps, and defense industries central to the war effort.

KEY POINT

Wartime migration and Tennessee's role transformed communities — millions moved to defense centers, straining housing, while Tennessee hosted training installations, POW camps, and defense industries central to the war effort.

Read the War Ration Book instructions — identify the issuing office and its purpose before you read the text.

WHO

Office of Price Administration

WHEN

1943

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

War Ration Book Instructions

Office of Price Administration · 1943

"This book is your Government's guarantee of your fair share of goods made scarce by war. Price ceilings and rationing are the most fair way to distribute scarce goods. Misuse of rationing stamps is a crime punishable by fine or imprisonment. Your Government needs your compliance."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.55:

The war effort, financed and supplied by home-front sacrifice, and regions like Tennessee that gained industry, bases, and jobs.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.55:

Civilians who gave up goods to rationing, families separated by wartime migration, and communities strained by rapid, crowded growth.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.55:

Federal agencies like the Office of Price Administration and War Production Board that set rationing, bond, and production policy.

Anchor: War Ration Book Instructions, Office of Price Administration, 1943 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Rationing

En español: *Racionamiento*

WHAT IT MEANS

Government-controlled limits on consumer goods during WWII to ensure adequate supplies for the military, requiring ration books and coupons.

War Bonds

En español: *Bonos de Guerra*

WHAT IT MEANS

Government bonds sold to citizens to finance the war effort, promoted through massive publicity campaigns featuring celebrities and patriotic appeals.

Rosie the Riveter

En español: *Rosie la Remachadora*

WHAT IT MEANS

Cultural icon representing millions of American women who worked in factories and shipyards during World War II, filling jobs left by men who went to war.

Check your understanding

What role did propaganda play in maintaining civilian morale and support for the war effort?

- A** Propaganda was not used during WWII, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- B** Propaganda only targeted military personnel, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C** The Office of War Information used films, posters, and radio to demonize enemies, celebrate American values, recruit workers, and build national unity through shared purpose and sacrifice
- D** Propaganda undermined the war effort, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.56

Manhattan Project & Atomic Bomb

TN STANDARD

US.56 – Describe the Manhattan Project and explain the rationale for using the atomic bomb to end the war.

I CAN

I can describe the Manhattan Project and explain the rationale for using the atomic bomb to end the war.

Oak Ridge, Tennessee anchored the Manhattan Project — the secret “Secret City” was chosen for uranium enrichment for its remote, secure location, abundant TVA power, and rail access, growing overnight to tens of thousands of workers.

KEY POINT

Oak Ridge, Tennessee anchored the Manhattan Project — the secret “Secret City” was chosen for uranium enrichment for its remote, secure location, abundant TVA power, and rail access, growing overnight to tens of thousands of workers.

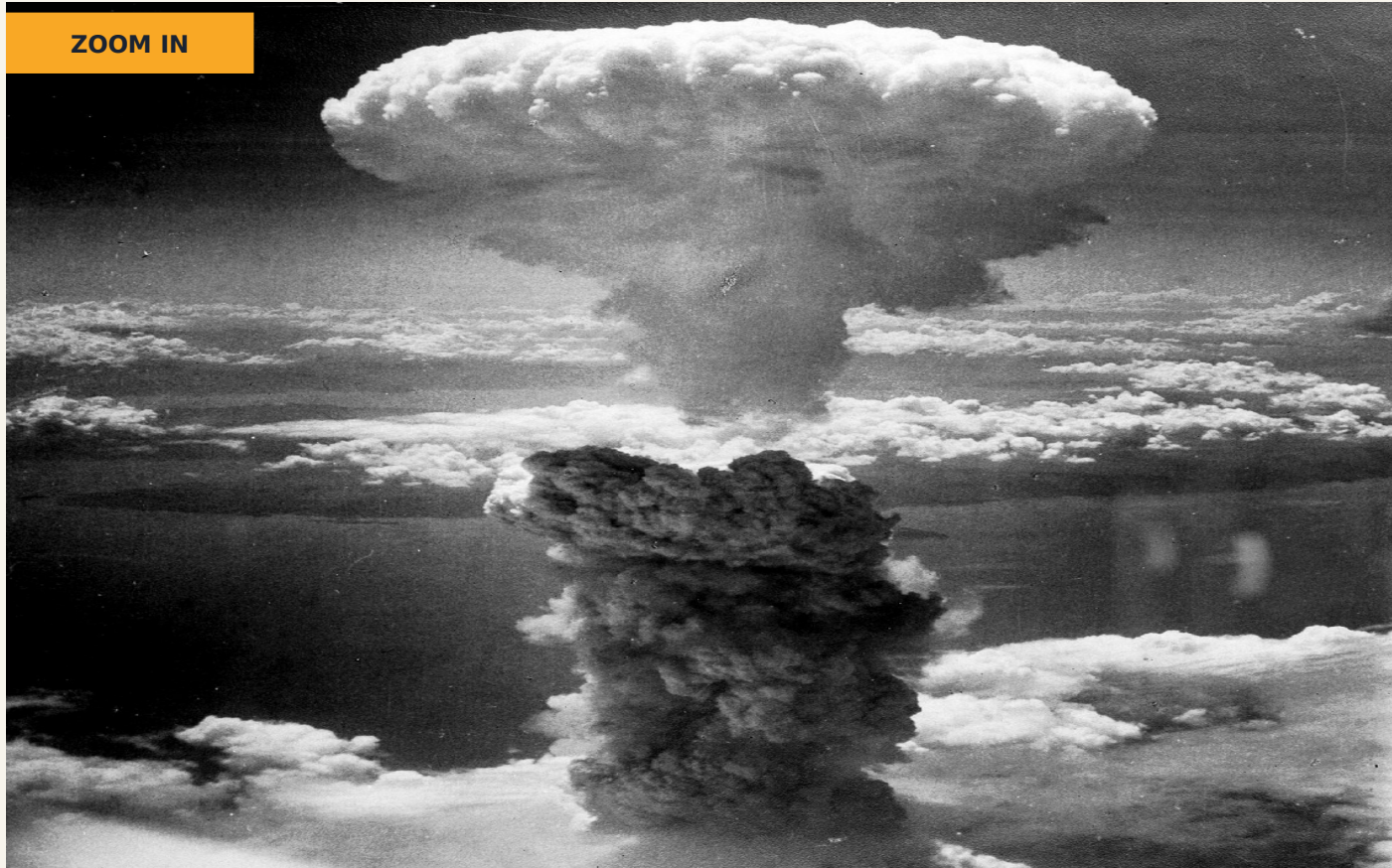
A vast secret program built the atomic bomb — Los Alamos, Oak Ridge, and Hanford employed over 125,000 people under General Groves and Oppenheimer, and the July 1945 Trinity test proved the weapon worked.

KEY POINT

A vast secret program built the atomic bomb — Los Alamos, Oak Ridge, and Hanford employed over 125,000 people under General Groves and Oppenheimer, and the July 1945 Trinity test proved the weapon worked.

Truman chose the bomb to end the war — facing projected casualties from a Japanese invasion, Truman authorized atomic strikes on Hiroshima and Nagasaki — a decision still debated for its human cost and long-term consequences.

ZOOM IN



Read Truman's Statement on the Atomic Bomb — note the speaker, date, and purpose before you read his words.

WHO

President Harry S. Truman

WHEN

August 6, 1945

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Statement on the Atomic Bomb

President Harry S. Truman · August 6, 1945

"Sixteen hours ago an American airplane dropped one bomb on Hiroshima, an important Japanese Army base. That bomb had more power than 20,000 tons of T.N.T... We are now prepared to obliterate more rapidly and completely every productive enterprise the Japanese have above ground in any city... If they do not now accept our terms they may expect a rain of ruin from the air."

[Harry S. Truman Presidential Library](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.56:

The United States, which ended the war and emerged as a nuclear superpower, and Oak Ridge, Tennessee, transformed by the project.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.56:

The tens of thousands of Japanese civilians killed and injured at Hiroshima and Nagasaki, and survivors who suffered lasting effects.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.56:

President Truman, who authorized the bombings, and the scientists and military leaders of the Manhattan Project who built the weapon.

Anchor: Statement on the Atomic Bomb, President Harry S. Truman, August 6, 1945 (Harry S. Truman Presidential Library)

Words you need before we read

Manhattan Project

En español: *Proyecto Manhattan*

WHAT IT MEANS

Top-secret U.S. program to develop the atomic bomb, involving sites at Oak Ridge (Tennessee), Los Alamos (New Mexico), and Hanford (Washington).

Atomic Bomb

En español: *Bomba Atómica*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nuclear weapons dropped on Hiroshima (August 6) and Nagasaki (August 9, 1945), killing over 200,000 people and forcing Japan's surrender, ending World War II.

Battle of Iwo Jima

En español: *Batalla de Iwo Jima*

WHAT IT MEANS

February-March 1945 brutal battle for a strategic Pacific island, famous for the iconic flag-raising photograph on Mount Suribachi.

Check your understanding

What factors influenced President Truman's decision to use atomic weapons against Japan?

- A** Truman made the decision without considering alternatives, which does not align with the documented historical record, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- B** Only military factors were considered, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C** Truman opposed using the bombs, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D** Projected invasion casualties based on Okinawa, desire to end the war quickly, demonstrating power to the Soviet Union, and Japanese refusal to surrender all influenced the decision

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.57

Yalta and Potsdam Conferences

TN STANDARD

US.57 – Explain the major outcomes of the Yalta and Potsdam Conferences.

I CAN

I can explain the major outcomes of the Yalta and Potsdam Conferences.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.57

Yalta shaped the postwar world — in February 1945 Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin agreed to found the United Nations, divide occupied Germany, and hold “free elections” in liberated Europe as Allied victory neared.

ZOOM IN



US.57 · Yalta Conference (February 1945)

Potsdam exposed the widening Allied split — in mid-1945 Truman, Stalin, and Churchill (then Attlee) met after Germany's surrender, but disputes over Eastern Europe and reparations revealed deepening distrust.

KEY POINT

Potsdam exposed the widening Allied split — in mid-1945 Truman, Stalin, and Churchill (then Attlee) met after Germany's surrender, but disputes over Eastern Europe and reparations revealed deepening distrust.

The conferences seeded the Cold War — Stalin’s version of “free elections” meant communist control, and irreconcilable disagreements over Eastern Europe turned wartime allies into postwar rivals.

KEY POINT

The conferences seeded the Cold War — Stalin’s version of “free elections” meant communist control, and irreconcilable disagreements over Eastern Europe turned wartime allies into postwar rivals.

Read the Yalta Conference Communiqué — weigh who issued it and why before you read the agreements.

WHO

Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin

WHEN

February 1945

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Yalta Conference Communiqué

Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin · February 1945

"We have agreed on common policies and plans for enforcing the unconditional surrender terms which we shall impose together on Nazi Germany... It is our inflexible purpose to destroy German militarism and Nazism and to ensure that Germany will never again be able to disturb the peace of the world."

[Avalon Project, Yale Law School](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.57:

The Soviet Union, which secured influence over Eastern Europe, and the Allies who set up the UN and postwar occupation zones.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.57:

The nations of Eastern Europe subjected to Soviet-backed communist governments despite promises of free elections.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.57:

The “Big Three” — Roosevelt (later Truman), Churchill (later Attlee), and Stalin — who negotiated the postwar settlement.

Anchor: Yalta Conference Communiqué, Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin, February 1945 (Avalon Project, Yale Law School)

Words you need before we read

Yalta Conference

En español: *Conferencia de Yalta*

WHAT IT MEANS

February 1945 meeting of Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin to plan post-war Europe, dividing Germany and establishing spheres of influence.

Potsdam Conference

En español: *Conferencia de Potsdam*

WHAT IT MEANS

July-August 1945 meeting of Truman, Churchill/Attlee, and Stalin finalizing plans for occupied Germany and issuing surrender terms to Japan.

Joseph Stalin

En español: *Joseph Stalin*

WHAT IT MEANS

Communist dictator of the Soviet Union (1924-1953) who ruled through terror, forced collectivization, and purges, resulting in millions of deaths.

Check your understanding

How did the Potsdam Conference reveal growing tensions between the United States and Soviet Union?

- A** Disputes over Eastern European governments, German reparations, and differing visions for post-war Europe revealed fundamental disagreements that would define the Cold War
- B** Potsdam showed complete Allied unity, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era
- C** Only minor disagreements emerged, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- D** The Soviet Union was excluded from Potsdam, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.58

Founding of the United Nations & Cordell Hull

TN STANDARD

US.58 – Identify and explain the reasons for the founding of the United Nations, including the role of Cordell Hull.

I CAN

I can identify and explain the reasons for the founding of the United Nations, including the role of Cordell Hull.

The League's failure taught hard lessons — the League of Nations collapsed because the U.S. never joined, it lacked enforcement power, and major powers ignored aggression — failures the UN was designed to avoid.

KEY POINT

The League's failure taught hard lessons — the League of Nations collapsed because the U.S. never joined, it lacked enforcement power, and major powers ignored aggression — failures the UN was designed to avoid.

Cordell Hull, a Tennessean, was “Father of the UN” — FDR’s long-serving Secretary of State was so central to planning the postwar peace organization that he won the 1945 Nobel Peace Prize for the effort.

KEY POINT

Cordell Hull, a Tennessean, was “Father of the UN” — FDR’s long-serving Secretary of State was so central to planning the postwar peace organization that he won the 1945 Nobel Peace Prize for the effort.

The UN secured what the League could not — founded in 1945 to maintain peace through collective security, the UN gained U.S. membership and has endured, though its power is limited by great-power vetoes.

ZOOM IN



Read the United Nations Charter Preamble — identify who wrote it and why before you analyze its aims.

WHO

United Nations

WHEN

June 26, 1945

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

United Nations Charter Preamble

United Nations · June 26, 1945

"We the peoples of the United Nations determined to save succeeding generations from the scourge of war, which twice in our lifetime has brought untold sorrow to mankind, and to reaffirm faith in fundamental human rights, in the dignity and worth of the human person, in the equal rights of men and women and of nations large and small."

United Nations

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.58:

The postwar world order and the U.S., now a leading member of a permanent peace organization, and Cordell Hull, honored with the Nobel Peace Prize.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.58:

Smaller nations whose interests could be overridden by great-power vetoes in the Security Council.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.58:

The founding Allied powers and diplomats like Cordell Hull who designed the UN, and the U.S. Senate, which this time approved membership.

Anchor: United Nations Charter Preamble, United Nations, June 26, 1945 (United Nations)

Words you need before we read

United Nations

En español: *United Nations*

WHAT IT MEANS

An international organization founded in 1945 by 50 nations to maintain global peace, security, and cooperation and to prevent another world war through collective diplomacy.

Cordell Hull

En español: *Cordell Hull*

WHAT IT MEANS

U.S. Secretary of State under Franklin D. Roosevelt (1933-1944), awarded the 1945 Nobel Peace Prize for his role in creating the United Nations.

Yalta Conference

En español: *Conferencia de Yalta*

WHAT IT MEANS

February 1945 meeting of Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin to plan post-war Europe, dividing Germany and establishing spheres of influence.

Check your understanding

What were the main goals of the United Nations, and how did they reflect wartime experiences?

- A** The UN had no connection to WWII experiences, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- B** Goals of maintaining peace, promoting human rights, enabling self-determination, and fostering cooperation directly addressed the failures that led to WWII—aggression, human rights violations, and economic nationalism
- C** The UN focused only on trade issues, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era
- D** Wartime experiences were irrelevant to UN design, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.